

bonus linux tips and tricks



These scenarios are available here:

https://github.com/ferguson-gvsu/cis_241_w_2026/tree/main/in_class_examples/linux_trick_examples

Scenario 1

Imagine you run 1s

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Imagine you run `ls` this is what you see:

```
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its_really_hard_to_come_up_with_long_directory_names  
this_is_a_directory  
you_think_this_name_is_outrageously_long_but_i_have_seen_
```

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Imagine we want to `cd` into the "you_think_..." dir

What if we're lazy?

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Start typing...

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Then hit **tab**!

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Start typing...

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Then hit **tab**!

Tab is a context-sensitive autocomplete in bash!

Scenario 2

Similar setup, you run `ls`:

```
a_directory  another_directory  another_one
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Then hit tab

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Nothing happens!

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a_directory  another_directory  another_one
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Then hit tab

Nothing happens!

It's ambiguous what you want to autocomplete!

Scenario 2

Similar setup, you run `ls`:

```
a_directory  another_directory  another_one  b_directory
```

You start typing: `cd a`

Then hit tab

Nothing happens!

It's ambiguous what you want to autocomplete!

Tab will not continue when there is uncertainty!

(also you can hit tab again to see options)

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Similar setup, you run `ls`:

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a_directory  another_directory  another_one  b_directory
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If you type `cd a_` and hit tab, it will autocomplete!

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Only one option that starts with `a_`

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If you type `cd an` and hit tab, it will *partially* autocomplete

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It's now unclear what you want.

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```
cd another_
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It's now unclear what you want.

Type one more letter (d or o) and you can autocomplete fully!

Scenario 3

Imagine you type a long command:

```
ssh username@eos11.gvsu.edu
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This brings back your last command.

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- You can use the home key to jump to the beginning
 - ctrl + a if you don't have a home key

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This brings back your last command.

- If you need to edit it, use arrow keys to move left/right
- You can use the home key to jump to the beginning
 - ctrl + a if you don't have a home key
- Hitting up multiple times will go back further in your history
 - Down arrow will move forward again

Scenario 4

Imagine you're in one directory and then you `cd` somewhere else on your system

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This is like a back button, but it only works for one step!

Scenario 5

Run this command:

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sleep 10d
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Your terminal is now "sleeping" for 10 days, oh no!

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How do we stop a command?

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Run this command:

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sleep 10d
```

Your terminal is now "sleeping" for 10 days, oh no!

How do we stop a command?

```
Ctrl + C
```

Scenario 6

Ol' Dr. Ferg is working through an example, and you'd like to follow along.

However, he hasn't mentioned where to get the example files?

What do yo do?

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Ol' Dr. Ferg is working through an example, and you'd like to follow along.

However, he hasn't mentioned where to get the example files?

What do yo do?

Please tell me! I always plan to tell you where to get the files, I just forget sometimes :^)